Extract One: *These first two cables, from the American embassy in Turkey, concern the possible sale of Boeing aircraft to Turkish Airlines. The Turkish transportation minister implies that Turkish Airlines would be more inclined to buy Boeing aircraft if the American government would help to put a Turkish astronaut in space. Bizarrely, despite lobbying on behalf of Boeing, the ambassador claims to resent the presence of political influence in such a transaction. In his own words: 'Yildirim's conflation of [US Government – Turkish Government] interactions and what is ostensibly a commercial sale between private firms suggests an unwelcome, but unsurprising, degree of political influence in this transaction.' The ambassador also resents lobbying by European governments on behalf of rival aircraft manufacturers, an activity which is widespread and common to all Western governments.*

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SUBJECT: BOEING FEELS PRESSURE IN THE TURKISH MARKET

1. (C) Summary: Boeing representatives continue to be concerned over attempts by a senior official of the AKP cabinet to pressure the company into hiring one of his associates as Boeing's representative in Turkey. Boeing is currently competing with EADS-Airbus for the potential sale of 19 narrow and wide body aircraft to expand the fleet of Turkish Airlines (THY). In addition to puchasing 19 aircraft and extending lease options for eight B737-400 aircraft, THY anticipates a need for 35 additional planes to meet future demand. End Summary.

2. (C) Earlier this week, Boeing representatives met with Embassy officials to discuss issues of concern to Boeing in the Turkish market. Boeing is concerned over attempts by a senior member of the AKP cabinet to pressure Boeing into hiring one of his associates as Boeing's representative in Turkey The state-owned Turkish flag carrier, THY, is currently interested in purchasing nineteen planes to expand its fleet. In addition to this fleet expansion, THY is also looking to lengthen its lease